

10. With reference to the water on the planet Earth, consider the following statements :

1. The amount of water in the rivers and lakes is more than the amount of groundwater.
2. The amount of water in polar ice caps and glaciers is more than the amount of groundwater.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. The largest amount of fresh water on our planet is in

- (a) River
(b) Lakes and streams
(c) Glaciers and mountains
(d) Underground water

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2015

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

12. On the planet Earth, most of the fresh water exists as ice caps and glaciers. Out of the remaining fresh water, the largest proportion

- (a) Is found in the atmosphere as moisture and clouds
(b) Is found in freshwater lakes and rivers
(c) Exists as groundwater
(d) Exists as soil moisture

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

13. Which one is the most extensive part of the oceanic floor?

- (a) Ocean Deep (b) Oceanic Slope
(c) Oceanic Shelves (d) Deep Sea Plains

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

A most extensive part of the oceanic floor is 'Deep Sea Plain'. Characterized by flat and rolling submarine plain it is the most extensive relief zone of the ocean basins. These deep-sea plains (Abyssal Plains) having the depth of 3000 m to 6000 meter cover more than 76% percent of the total area of the ocean basins.

14. Red sea is an example of :

- (a) Volcanic valley (b) Eroded valley
(c) Axial trough (d) U-shaped valley

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

The Red Sea is an example of an axial trough, which lies between Africa and Arabia. A magnetic anomaly has been determined in this area. Countries with desert climates are located around the Red Sea due to high temperatures throughout the year. The cities of Jidd, Hejaz, Egypt, Suez and Aqaba etc. are situated on its banks. Due to the connection of North Africa and Europe with the countries of Asia through the Suez Canal, its commercial importance has increased significantly.

15. Out of the following which combination is incorrect?

- (a) Telegraph Plateau - Indian Ocean
(b) Cocoa Ridge - Pacific Ocean
(c) Walvis Ridge - Atlantic Ocean
(d) Agulhas Basin - Indian Ocean

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Telegraph Plateau is in the Atlantic Ocean. So, only option (a) is incorrectly matched while all others are correctly matched, therefore, option (a) is the right answer.

Important Seas of the World

In terms of geography, a sea is a part of the ocean partially enclosed by land. Seas are smaller than the oceans and are usually located where the land and ocean meet.

Some important seas of the world are as follows-

*The **South China Sea** is a marginal sea that is a part of the Pacific Ocean. It is located between China, Taiwan, the Philippines, Malaysia, Brunei, Indonesia and Vietnam. Its maximum depth is 5,377 m.

*The **Bering Sea** is also a marginal sea of the Pacific Ocean. Covering a total area of 2520000 sq. km, it has a maximum depth of 3500 m.

*The **Mediterranean Sea** is a sea connected to the Atlantic Ocean. It is the largest of all seas enclosed by land. It extends between North Africa, Southern Europe, Anatolia and Levant. The maximum known depth of the Mediterranean Sea is 5267 m.

*The **Black Sea** is a marginal sea of the Atlantic Ocean, located in the south-east of Europe. The Black Sea is surrounded by Europe, Caucasus and the Anatolia Peninsula.

*The **Caspian sea** is the world's largest inland body of water, and world's largest saltwater lake. It is also the world's largest lake. It covers a total area of 371000 sq. km. It has borders with Russia, Azerbaijan, Turkmenistan, Iran and Kazakhstan.

*The **Sea of Azov** is a sea in Eastern Europe, that is almost completely enclosed by land, having just a narrow opening into the Black Sea via Strait of Kerch. The sea borders Ukraine in the North, Russia in the east and Crimea Peninsula in the west.

*The **Aral Sea** is an important water body in Central Asia. It lies between Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan.

***Sargasso Sea** is a water body in the North Atlantic Ocean. The sea is bounded by Gulf Stream on the west and north-west, North Atlantic Current/Drift on the North, Canary Current in the East, Azores Current on the northeast, Antilles Current on the South-West and North Atlantic Equatorial Current on the south. The sea is named after the Sargasso seaweed, which is found in abundance in the region.

*The **Tyrrhenian sea** is a part of the Mediterranean Sea off the western coast of Italy. The sea is bounded by Corsica, Sardinia, Italy and Sicily. The Tyrrhenian sea is linked to other seas of the region through the Strait of Messina, Strait of Bonifacio and Corsica Channel.

*The countries of Africa surrounding the **Mediterranean Sea** are Egypt, Libya, Tunisia, Algeria and Morocco etc.

*The Middle-Eastern Asian country of Jordan does not have any boundaries with the Mediterranean Sea.

*Turkiye is a transcontinental country located mainly in western Asia with a small portion of it lying in south-east Europe. Turkiye is bordered by the Black Sea in the North, Mediterranean Sea in South **Aegean Sea** in West Turkiye and **Marmara Sea** in the Northwest.

*The Black Sea and Mediterranean Sea determine the north and southern political borders of Turkiye respectively.

*Turkiye shares borders with 8 countries which are as follows- Bulgaria in the Northwest, Greece in the West, Georgia in the Northeast. Iran, Armenia and Azerbaijan in the East, Iraq and Syria in the Southeast.

1. **Baku, the capital city of Azerbaijan is situated along the coast of which one of the following seas?**

- (a) Black Sea (b) Levantine Sea

(c) Caspian Sea

(d) Aral Sea

U.P. B.E.O. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

The capital of Azerbaijan, Baku, is its largest city located along the Caspian Sea coast. It is to the east of Azerbaijan. Azerbaijan is a Muslim majority (but secular) country in Europe. The Caspian Sea is the largest saltwater lake.

2. **Towards the North of Turkey is –**

(a) Black Sea

(b) Caspian Sea

(c) Red Sea

(d) Mediterranean Sea

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (a)

The Black Sea lies to the north of Turkey. Turkey borders 8 countries and 4 seas, given as follows –
In the North-West- Bulgaria
In the West- Greece
In the North-East - Georgia
In the East- Iran, Azerbaijan and Armenia
In the South-East - Iraq and Syria
Seas bordering Turkey are –
In the North-Black Sea
Towards West-Aegean and in the North-west Sea of Marmara
In South - The Mediterranean Sea.
Therefore, it is clear that the Black Sea is located in the north of Turkiye.

3. **Turkey is located between –**

(a) The Black Sea and the Caspian Sea

(b) The Black Sea and the Mediterranean Sea

(c) Gulf of Suez and the Mediterranean Sea

(d) Gulf of Aqaba and the Dead Sea

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (b)

Turkey (now Turkiye) is located in Eurasia. Some of its parts are located in Southeast Europe. The major part of this country is located in West Asia. To the north of Turkiye is the Black Sea, to the south is the Mediterranean Sea and to the west is the Aegean Sea while to the north-west is sea of Marmara. The Black Sea and the Mediterranean Sea define the political boundaries of Turkiye in the north and south respectively. Hence (b) is the correct answer.

4. **The correct sequence of the following seas from west to east is :**

(a) Black Sea, Mediterranean Sea, Caspian Sea, Aral Sea

(b) Caspian Sea, Mediterranean Sea, Black Sea, Aral Sea

- (c) Mediterranean Sea, Black Sea, Caspian Sea, Aral Sea
(d) Black Sea, Mediterranean Sea, Aral Sea, Caspian Sea

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

The correct sequence of seas from west to east is : **Georgia. Mediterranean Sea:** It is the largest sea encircled by land. It is connected with Atlantic Ocean through the Strait of Gibraltar.

Black Sea: It is a continental sea surrounded by Southeast Europe, Caucasus, Anatolia Peninsula.

Caspian Sea: It is the largest saltwater lake. River Volga merges into the Caspian Sea. This sea is surrounded by Kazakhstan, Russia, Azerbaijan, Turkmenistan and Iran.

Aral Sea: It is located in Central Asia and is surrounded by Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan.

5. The inland sea is the :

- (a) White Sea (b) Black Sea
(c) Caspian Sea (d) Sea of Japan

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

The Caspian Sea is the world's largest inland sea. It is the world's largest lake with a total area of approximately 371000 sq. km.

6. Sargasso Sea is related to the Ocean, that ocean is –

- (a) Northern Pacific (b) Northern Atlantic
(c) Southern Pacific (d) Southern Atlantic

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

Sargasso Sea is a region of the North Atlantic Ocean. It has been named after sargassum seaweed abundantly found in this region.

7. Where is Sargasso sea situated?

- (a) North Atlantic Ocean (b) South Atlantic Ocean
(c) Indian ocean (d) North Pacific Ocean

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

The 'Sargasso sea' is located in the North Atlantic Ocean. It is the only sea without a land boundary. Illustration of Sargassum and associated marine life, including fish, sea turtles, birds and marine mammals.

8. The Sargasso Sea is a part of the-

- (a) Indian Ocean (b) Arctic Ocean
(c) North Atlantic Ocean (d) South Atlantic Ocean
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above.

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2022

Ans. (c)

The Sargasso Sea is a water region in the North Atlantic Ocean. In this region Sargassum is found in abundance, due to which it was named Sargasso.

9. The Sargasso Sea is characterized by –

- (a) very cold water (b) very warm water
(c) highly saline water (d) typical marine vegetation

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Which of the following seas does not have a coastline?

- (a) Black Sea (b) Sargasso Sea
(c) Sea of Azov (d) Caspian Sea

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

Sargasso Sea in the North Atlantic is bounded by the Gulf Stream on the west and northwest, the North Atlantic Drift/current on the north, Azores current on the northeast Antilles current on the southwest, the Canary current on the east, and the North Atlantic equatorial current on the south. The Sargasso Sea is a region in the middle of the North Atlantic Ocean and thus does not have a coastline.

11. The sea surrounded by Italy, Sicily, Sardinia and Corsica is –

- (a) Adriatic Sea (b) Aegean Sea
(c) Ligurian Sea (d) Tyrrhenian Sea

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (d)

The Tyrrhenian Sea is situated in the region of the Mediterranean Sea bounded by the island of Corsica and Sardinia, the Italian peninsula and the island of Sicily.

12. Which of the following pairs of countries are around the Aral Sea?

- (a) Kazakhstan - Uzbekistan
(b) Kazakhstan - Turkmenistan
(c) Azerbaijan - Uzbekistan
(d) Kazakhstan - Russia

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

The Aral Sea is a lake in Central Asia. It is bordered by Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan.

13. Which one of the following African countries does not border with the Mediterranean Sea ?

- (a) Algeria (b) Chad
(c) Morocco (d) Tunisia

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (b)

African countries namely Algeria, Morocco, Tunisia, Libya and Egypt border with the Mediterranean sea but 'Chad' is a landlocked country.

14. Which one of the following countries of South-West Asia does not open out to the Mediterranean Sea?

- (a) Syria (b) Jordan
(c) Lebanon (d) Israel

I.A.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Jordan is an Arabian country in middleeast Asia that does not open out to the Mediterranean Sea. It is bordered by Saudi Arabia to southeast and south, Iraq to northeast, Syria to the north, Israel and Palestinian West Bank occupied by Israel and the Dead Sea to the west, and Red Sea to southwest. The capital of Jordan is Amman.

15. Which of the following seas is near the 'Gaza Strip'?

- (a) Mediterranean Sea (b) Red Sea
(c) Black Sea (d) Caspian Sea

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Gaza Strip borders the Mediterranean Sea between Egypt and Israel. Significantly, the Gaza Strip has been under the de facto governing authority of the Islamic Resistance Movement (HAMAS) since 2007.

16. Which of the following is the deepest ocean?

- (a) South China Sea (b) Bering Sea
(c) Mediterranean sea (d) Sea of Japan

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (a)

The (approximate) depths of the seas given in the options are respectively South China Sea (5377 m.), Bering Sea (3500m.), Mediterranean Sea (5267m.), Sea of Japan (3742m.). So it is clear that the South China Sea is the deepest.

17. Consider the following pairs :

Sea	Bordering country
1. Adriatic Sea	: Albania
2. Black Sea	: Croatia
3. Caspian Sea	: Kazakhstan
4. Mediterranean Sea	: Morocco
5. Red Sea	: Syria

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) 1, 2 and 4 only (b) 1, 3 and 4 only

(c) 2 and 5 only

(d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Countries bordering Mediterranean Sea in clockwise order are Spain, France, Monaco, Italy, Slovenia, Croatia, Bosnia & Herzegovina, Montenegro, Albania, Greece, Turkiye, Syria, Lebanon, Israel, Palestine, Egypt, Libya, Tunisia, Algeria & Morocco; Malta and Cyprus are island countries in the sea. Countries bordering Red Sea : There are six countries (Saudi Arabia, Yemen, Egypt, Sudan, Eritrea and Djibouti). Hence option b is the correct answer. Albania and Croatia are bordering countries of Adriatic Sea and Kazakhstan is a bordering country of the Caspian sea.

18. Which of the following countries is NOT located on the bank of the Black Sea?

- (a) Syria (b) Turkey
(c) Georgia (d) Bulgaria

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

Six countries bordering the Black Sea - 1. Russia, 2. Ukraine, 3. Romania, 4. Bulgaria, 5. Turkiye, 6. Georgia. Syria is situated on the eastern coast of the Mediterranean Sea. Syria is bordered by Turkiye, Iraq, Jordan, Lebanon and Israel. The Golan Heights of Syria have been forcefully occupied by Israel since 1967.

19. Red sea is an example of

- (a) Volcanic Valley (b) Eroded valley
(c) Axial trough (d) U-shaped valley

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

The Red Sea is an example of the axial trough located between Africa and Arabia. This region is associated with magnetic anomalies. It plays a pivotal role in trade between North Africa, Europe and Asian nations after the opening of the Suez Canal.

20. The Mediterranean Sea is a border of which of the following countries?

1. Jordan 2. Iraq
3. Lebanon 4. Syria

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)